

ROCK AND METAL

Bandland
Bengaluru *Nov. 23-24*

A pair of American groups, heavy metal-heads **Avenged Sevenfold** and rock outfit Extreme will headline the second edition of this festival, which will also feature two acts from the UK, art rock exponents Everything Everything and punk duo Big Special, as well as Lebanese psychedelic rock purveyors The Wanton Bishops.
bandland.in



While the dates are out for both the NH7 Weekender in Pune, which will be held on December 14-15, 2024, and the Mahindra Blues Festival in Mumbai, which will take place on February 8-9, 2025, the line-ups haven't been announced yet. Check nh7.in and mahindrablues.com for updates.

–Amit Gurbaxani

PROFILE

Legendary Act

Rock band **Extreme** *is headlining the Bandland music festival in Bengaluru this November*

"Are you married or ever been married?" asks Nuno Bettencourt, the guitarist of the American quartet Extreme when we ask him the secret behind the longevity of his group, which has briefly split up and gone on hiatus during the course of its career spanning four decades. "It's like being married to three different people at the same time. It's not an easy task, but the glue is always the music. Performing live is probably the most important part that keeps a band wanting to do it."

Recording, Bettencourt believes, is something acts "have to do to promote yourself". Indeed, Extreme has released just six albums, but has regularly toured across the world. The axeman and his band mates, vocalist Gary Cherone, bassist Pat Badger, and drummer Kevin Figueiredo, will return to India this November to headline the second edition of the Bengaluru-based rock music festival Bandland, which is promoted and produced by BookMyShow Live.

Bettencourt—who had a stint as part of Rihanna's live band—says that audiences in two different countries are never the same. "[In] every culture, the way they listen to your music, the way they respond, the way they communicate, it's always different." In India, where Extreme staged their debut show at the ShiRock festival in the Manipuri town of Ukhrul in 2018, he found that "the passion you have for the arts and film and music really comes across".

> Extreme has released just **six albums** but has regularly toured across the world

The crowd's reaction made the group want to come back, "without a doubt". Bettencourt says that if it were up to him, "we would have rather played a good 10 to 20 times over there over the last 38 years". This time around, in addition to their most well-known tunes, fans will get to hear cuts from their 2023 album *Six* as well as covers of tracks by rock legends such as Van Halen—for which Cherone served as the lead singer during the second half of the 1990s—and Queen.

The most anticipated part of their set at Bandland is likely to be the rendition of acoustic ballad 'More Than Words', the 1991 US No.1 that stands out among their mostly heavy material. They reportedly started to dislike playing the hit after its popularity started overshadowing the rest of their repertoire. Bettencourt refutes this. "I don't think it ever annoyed us," he says. "I think we annoyed each other. That was just a period when the band was not connected. We were young and stupid and taking it out on the song when we were not getting on very well. It's always been a special song and [performing it] has always been a pretty special moment." ■

–Amit Gurbaxani

Extreme will headline the second day of the Bandland festival at the Nice Grounds in Bengaluru on November 23 and 24. General admission tickets, starting at Rs 3,499 per day, are being sold on BookMyShow.com



CAPTIVATING QUARTET From left, Kevin Figueiredo, Gary Cherone, Pat Badger and Nuno Bettencourt